

Leading People

TOPIC LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Upon successful completion of this topic, the student will be able to:

1. Describe what it means to effectively lead people.
2. Discuss how the Charge of Command expects leaders to develop others.
3. Recognize the importance of Responsibility, Accountability and Authority in the execution of your positions throughout your careers.
4. Discuss the advantages of intent-based leadership in a complex environment.
5. Identify the importance of teambuilding and building trust.
6. Recognize the goals of the Navy's Get Real, Get Better program

STUDENT PREPARATION

Student Support Material

1. Leading People Discussion Guide

Primary References

1. CNO 34, The Charge of Command, 07NOV25
2. Turn the Ship Around by Captain (ret) David Marquet, DoD MWR Library and Libby App
3. The Speed of Trust by Stephen M. R. Covey, DoD MWR Library and Libby App
4. Team of Teams by General (ret) Stanley McCrystal, DoD MWR Library and Libby App

Additional References

Overview

- Leadership
  - Styles
  - Characteristics
  - Responsibility, Accountability, and Authority
- Leadership expectations
  - CNO's Day One Message and Charge of Command
  - Get Real Get Better
- Intent-based leadership

Leadership styles

- Vision
- Coaching
- Affiliation
- Democratic
- Pace setting
- Commanding
- What leadership style have you observed?
- Are leadership styles situational dependent?

Responsibility, Accountability, and Authority

- Responsibility
  - The quality or state of being responsible such as moral, legal, or mental accountability
- Accountability
  - The quality or state of being accountable, especially an obligation or willingness to accept responsibility or to account for one's actions
- Authority
  - Power to influence or command thought, opinion, or behavior

Leadership Characteristics

- What are characteristics of a good leader?
- What are characteristics of a bad leader?
- What personal experiences have shaped your thoughts on leadership?

What kind of leader are you or do you intend to become?

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Leadership Expectations
CNO34 Day One Message



Chief of Naval Operations
Admiral Daryl Caudle

FOUNDRY: We will strengthen our industrial base to accelerate shipbuilding, modernize infrastructure, and deliver a combat-ready fleet on time

FLEET: We will build a world-class, integrated force of people and platforms, ready to project global power alongside our Joint and Allied partners

FIGHT: We will win decisively at sea by innovating at the speed of relevance and integrating advanced technology to guarantee our lethality and survivability

Measures of Success

- On time platform delivery and repair
- Fully manned, combat-ready ships
- Ordnance production meeting demand
- Eliminated repair part backlogs
- Sailors trained to mastery

Charge of Command



The Charge of Command

Admiral Caudle's expectations for leadership (November 7, 2025)

- Earned through proven performance; ***lead with integrity, courage, and humility***
- Sailor are the lifeblood of our Fleet and our decisive advantage; ***invest in your people***
- Risk is Commander's business, and you are a risk owner; ***make balanced decisions***
- Success comes from preparation, hard work, and learning from failure; ***have a plan, stress it, learn and innovate, build a command that learns quickly***
- ***When you're in command, command***; never lose sight of the privilege and gravity of command - it is the highest honor the Navy can bestow

Sacred Trust – Own It – Build And Lead Your Team

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Get Real, Get Better (GRGB)

The Charge of Command

Congratulations on your selection to the most consequential and influential job in our Nation's military: Command. You have earned this position through proven performance and your future potential – and with it comes the responsibility to lead with integrity, courage, and humility. You now shoulder the burden and privilege of leading warfighters at a strategic inflection point – one that may define the future of American sea power. Your unit's combat readiness is not just preparation; it is homework for combat. Your ability to lead under pressure will determine victory if called upon. Build a warfighting culture rooted in trust, accountability, and ownership. Set a clear vision, build resilience, and ensure every Sailor understands the mission, their role in it, and the "why" behind every task.

"The excellence of our people has long been our heritage – it is my source of strength" – ADM Elmo Zumwalt. Our Navy's true asymmetric advantage is not technology – it's our Sailors. They are the lifeblood of the fleet and the decisive edge in any conflict. As Commanding Officer, you must resist the temptation of transactional leadership. Invest in your people with the same intensity you invest in operational readiness. Train them to the highest standard. Take care of their families. Hold the line on accountability. Culture isn't built overnight – it is forged through discipline, transparency, and consistency. Show ownership. Model humility. Learn fast and let your team see you doing it. Communicate clearly, often, and with purpose – so your Sailors know exactly what to do when no one is watching. Build system that give you deep insight into how and why your unit executes its mission. A unified, high-performing command is built through trust earned in adversity and excellence demanded every day.

"It seems to be a law of nature, inflexible and inexorable, that those who will not risk cannot win" – CAPT John Paul Jones. Risk is Commander's business – and you are now an accountable risk owner. You must deliberately manage operational risk with judgment and resolve. Give clear, actionable Commander's Intent and empower your team under Mission Command principles to execute. You will face uncertainty; make balanced decisions that leverage reversibility, experience, teamwork and objectives. That's why you wear the command pin. Risk is rarely eliminated – it's transferred, and most often, downward to the deckplate. If you don't take ownership of it, someone else will – with less context and less clarity. Master your craft. Sharpen your decision-making cycles. Design repeatable processes that mitigate risk without erasing initiative. The greatest risk to any command is a zero-defect mindset – it breeds fear and paralysis. To win, you must foster a culture willing to take disciplined risk in order to execute with boldness and confidence.

"There are no secrets to success. It is the result of preparation, hard work, and learning from failure" – GEN Colin Powell. In combat, timing beats speed and precision beats power every time – therefore, your command must plan, execute, assess, and adapt faster than any adversary. Once you build a plan, stress it. Rehearse, test assumptions, and refine execution in



- Navy-wide culture renovation, where Get Real Get Better is the standard of leadership and problem-solving by which leaders at all levels embrace and live
- We are building teams that are self-assessing, self-correcting, and always learning toward one goal - delivering warfighting advantage

GRGB Behaviors

- Get Real: Act transparently (self-assess transparently)
  - Align on standards and goals
  - Find and embrace the red
- Get Better: Focus on what matters most (self-correct effectively)
  - Use proven problem-solving methods
  - Fix or elevate barriers
- Build learning teams (always learning; self-improve powerfully)
  - Encourage learning through trust and respect
  - Specify ownership

"Strategic Competition and the Call to Action"
https://www.milsuite.mil/video/watch/video/57915

GRGB: Navy's Learning Journey

Navy Experience

External Benchmarking



What We've Learned

Our Traditional Behavior

- Impress with scope of activity
- Recommendations centered on inputs ($, people, spares)
- Emphasize the green – zero defect mentality
- Fix within – don't ask for help (would require transparency)
- Governance success = no taskers
- Cross-functional issues by committee w/o clear accountability
- "Flag level" means little detail/data, vision vice results
- Fear, distrust, intransparency, risk aversion, status quo thinking

Best Practices to Drive Outcomes, Improvement

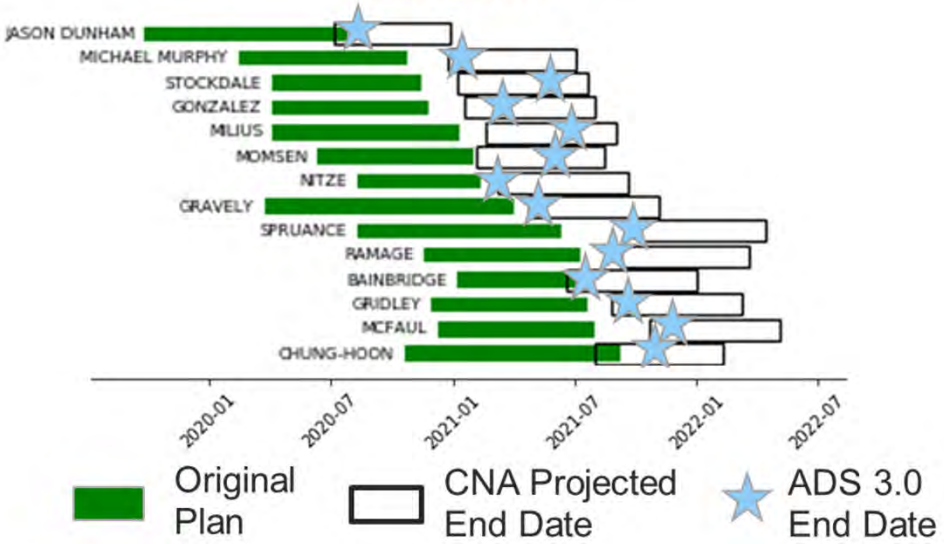
- Focus on outcomes – measurable baseline, goals, drivers
- Pursue highest-leverage drivers – data-driven cause/effect relationships
- Embrace the red – use off-plan performance to learn, adjust course
- "Fix or elevate" barriers with urgency, specificity, accountability
- Clear C2 – single accountable leader, defined supported / supporting roles
- Collaborative problem solving – leverage diverse perspectives, expertise
- Visual daily management – go to Gemba, rally around data, remove process
- Foundation of transparency and trust – candor + learning mindset

P2P: Perform to plan
NSS: Navy Sustainment System
CNRMC: Commander, Navy Regional Maintenance Center
NPIER: Navy Performance Improvement Educational Resource

GRGB: Analytics and Actions

CNRMC example

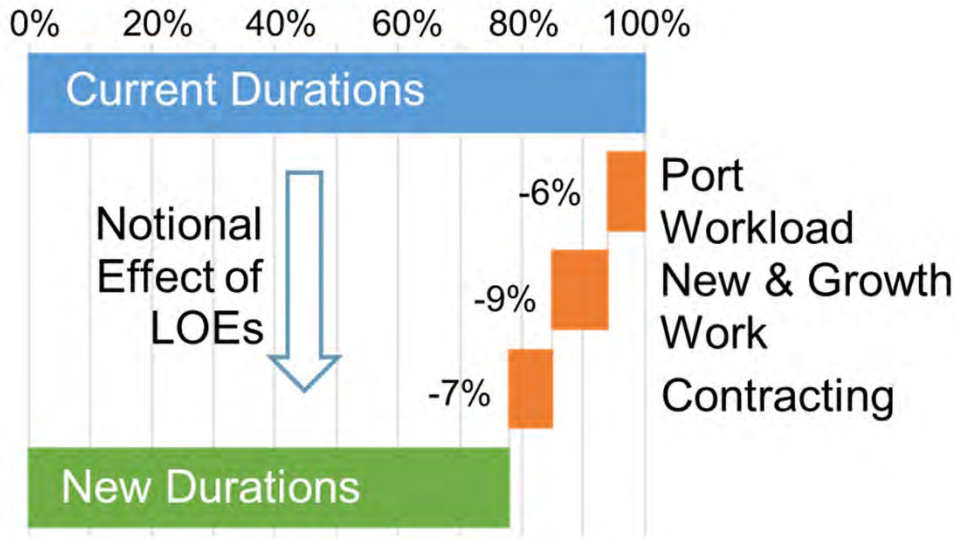
Get Real



Analytics: Developed and tested duration forecasting machine learning models that improved availability planning accuracy by 30-50%

Navy Action: Updated the planning process to reflect realistic duration timelines; this reduces churn in schedules and budgets

Get Better



Analytics: Developed key lever model that identified nine high-leverage improvement areas and quantified the potential ROI of SWE LOEs

Navy Action: Currently developing and implementing 10 LOEs targeting critical factors for reducing availability durations

P2P SWE has identified and started improving 10+ key levers

Get Better: Analysis of leverage

- P2P key lever analysis identifies areas that drive the most improvement
  - Highlight Navy-controlled levers to prioritize, swarm, and escalate for barrier removal

Tier 2 Driver Section	Driver	Historical average (FY 14 to present)	Change this driver to…	Has this effect on duration*
Workload Demand vs Past Performance	T2: Workload Demand vs. Past Performance	106%**	101%	-2% duration
	T3: Workload Instability	17%**	12%	-4% duration
	T3: Work-Density	225 MD/Day	215 MD/Day	-1% duration
New Work	T2: % New Work (NW)	6%	1%	-4% duration
	T3: % NW Discovered by 40% Completion	79%	84%	-4% duration
Growth Work	T2: % Growth Work (GW)	21%	16%	-5% duration
	T3: % GW Discovered by 40% Completion	56%	61%	-5% duration
New & Growth Work	T4: Ave Contract Change Cycle Time (LOE2CC)	38 Days	28 Days	-1% duration
Contract Award	T2: On-time Contract Award	Late (46% on time)	On-time	-4% duration
Integrated Schedule	T2: Weekly IPS First Pass Yield	59%	69%	-1% duration

Data: SURFMEPP ACT 08/21, NMD 08/21, SMDII 08/21.

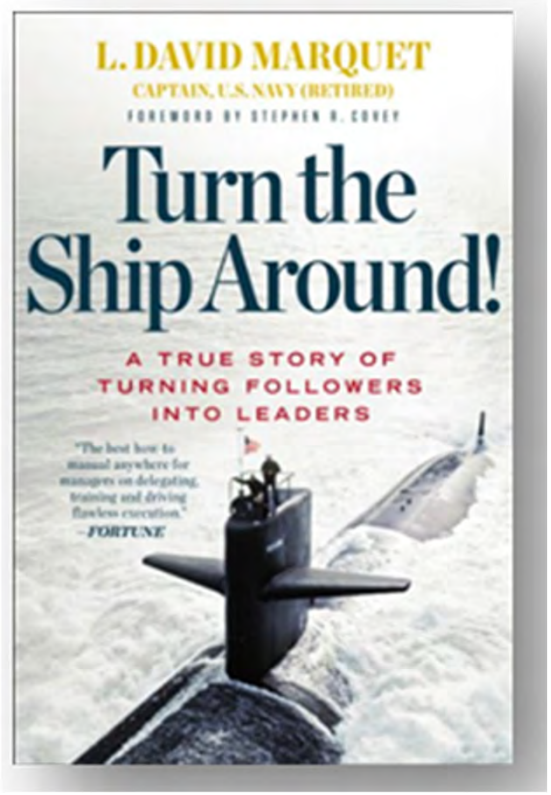
* Duration is measured as a % of planned duration, e.g. final duration of 360 vs. a plan of 300 is measured as 120%
** Workload metric analysis for CONUS NSA executing at least 100 MD/Day before SOA and <50% deviation in maximum number of avails in NSA

Key lever modeling highlights Navy-controlled levers to prioritize, swarm, and escalate for barrier removal

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Intent-based Leadership



Captain Marquet's experience on the USS SANTE FE and his implementation of intent-based leadership: https://www.youtube.com/embed/pYKH2uSax8U



Building Blocks of Intent-Based Leadership

Making decisions concerning not only how we are going to work, but to what end.

People are technically competent to make the decisions they make.



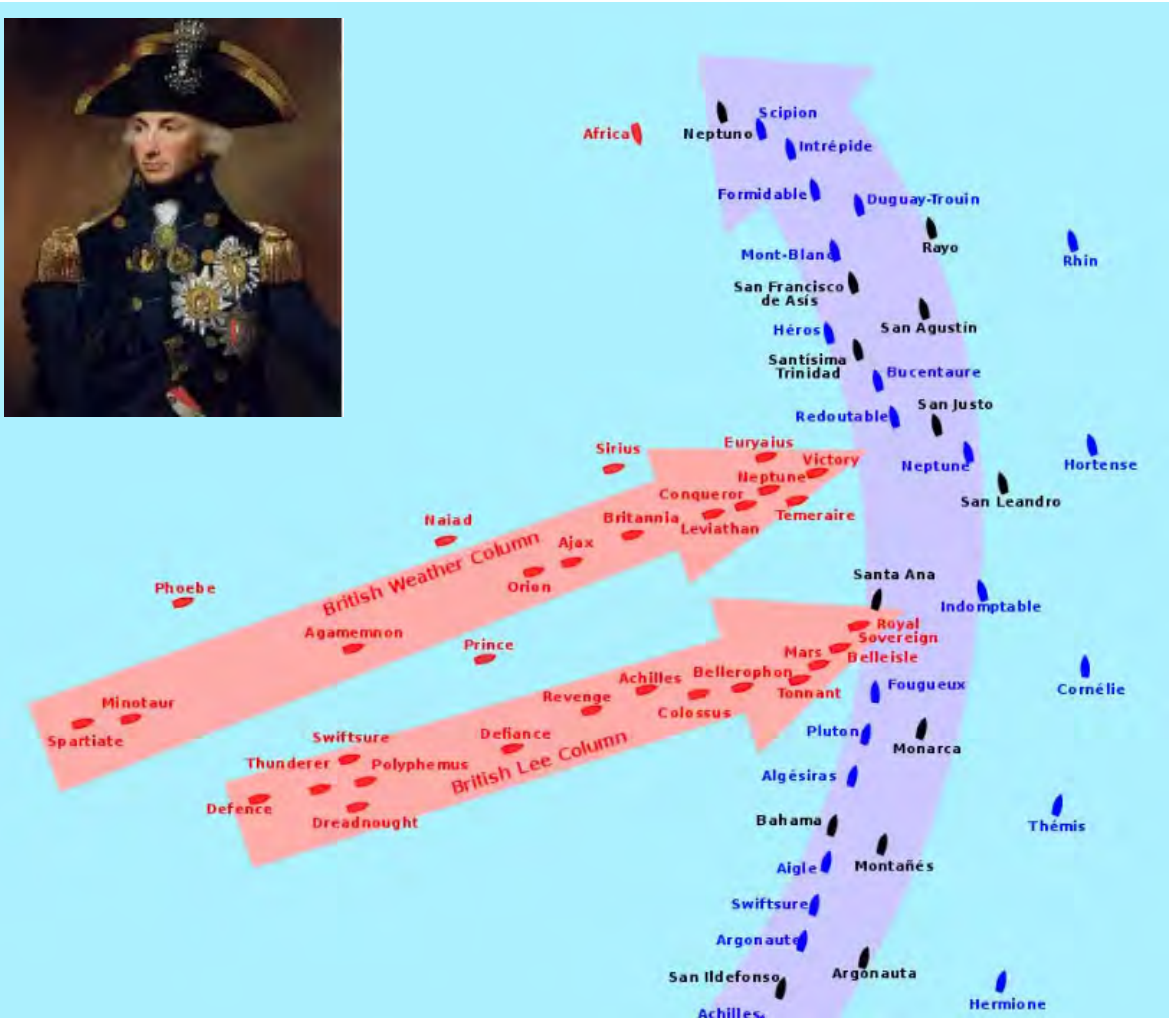
People at all levels of the organization clearly and completely know what the organization is about (and what role they play in it).

Team of Teams

The English are outmatched – 27 ships to 33 ships







"No Captain can do very wrong if he places his ship alongside that of the enemy."

Team of Teams - Nelson

- Nelson described the plan to his captains on September 29 and provide a secret memo on October 9 with the specifics of the columns
- Nelson was a brilliant man with an ingenious plan who pulled a marvelous trick and won an uphill battle, but…
- Seeds of victory were laid long before the battle and his famous line of “place his ship alongside that of the enemy”
- The “Nelson touch” – the idea that individual commanders should act on their own initiative once the battle began
- Nelson crafted an organizational culture that rewarded individual action and critical thinking, as opposed to simple execution command

Where Do You Start?

- "As effective Navy leaders, we must demonstrate a deliberate commitment to grow personally and professionally throughout our careers." CNO LDF 3.0
- Expand your knowledge and understanding leadership through routine exploration
  - Books (e.g., Team of Teams, Speed of Trust, etc.)
    - Free audio and digital library via DoD MWR Library and Libby App
  - Podcasts (e.g., Harvard Business Review, self-guided learning, etc.)
  - LinkedIn Learning
    - Thousands of professional and academic topics
    - Sponsored by NAVSEA, lead Course Director is your registration POC

Summary

- Leadership and leading people are dynamic and multi-faceted activities
- Our individual experiences (good and bad) shape our leadership style
- Properly placed and exercised Responsibility, Accountability, and Authority are critical to success
- Intent based leadership, built on competence and clarity, is a proven method to leverage the talents and energy of an organization